

BotBot Evolve — Hourly Report

Thursday 10 September 2026, 07:44

Interviews in this batch: 3

Cycle 3 — Locksmith services and small appliance repair / Deeply suspicious of technology and anything 'in writing.' Derek answers WhatsApp messages reluctantly, often replying hours or days late, and constantly questions why people don't just phone or come in person. He refuses to confirm prices or bookings over text ('could be anyone reading this'), asks who's asking and why, distrusts links/photos sent to him, and frequently tells customers to call the shop landline instead. When he does answer, he's blunt and short, sometimes typing in fragments, and occasionally goes silent mid-conversation if he decides the topic should be discussed 'properly' on the phone. — score 7.33/10

Cycle 4 — Custom bicycle building, e-bike conversions, and bike repair / Chronically indecisive and self-contradicting — Mei-Ling will confidently state a price, policy, or timeline, then reverse herself minutes later without acknowledging the change. She often blames it on 'still thinking it over' or 'actually, wait,' and customers frequently get two or three different answers to the same question in one conversation. She's enthusiastic and not trying to deceive anyone — she genuinely keeps changing her mind — but it makes pinning her down maddening. — score 6.33/10

Cycle 5 — Driving school & LTO license/permit processing assistance / Code-switches constantly and unpredictably between Tagalog and English mid-sentence, sometimes mid-word — often answering the substance of a question in Tagalog while the English part of her reply is just filler ('yeah so basically...'), which means non-Tagalog speakers frequently miss the actual answer buried in there. She's warm, uses lots of 'po,' 'ay,' and voice-note-style typing (run-ons, no punctuation), and will sometimes answer a totally different question than the one asked because she skimmed the message. She's not trying to be difficult — this is just how she talks to everyone, customers and family alike. — score 6.67/10

Problems found

Cycle 3 (Locksmith services and small appliance repair / Deeply suspicious of technology and anything 'in writing.' Derek answers WhatsApp messages reluctantly, often replying hours or days late, and constantly questions why people don't just phone or come in person. He refuses to confirm prices or bookings over text ('could be anyone reading this'), asks who's asking and why, distrusts links/photos sent to him, and frequently tells customers to call the shop landline instead. When he does answer, he's blunt and short, sometimes typing in fragments, and occasionally goes silent mid-conversation if he decides the topic should be discussed 'properly' on the phone.)

- MAJOR OMISSION: Emergency lockout pricing (£65 call-out + £35 labour, cash preferred, card machine 'usually works') was never asked about. Birdie walked through lock changes, key cutting, safe opening, and appliance repair pricing in detail but skipped the flagship emergency service's price entirely — even though Derek's own escalation policy for lockouts was discussed at length ('Straight to the landline, every time'). The bot will have no price to quote for its single most time-critical service.
- Cash-preferred / card-machine-unreliable detail was never surfaced, despite being directly relevant since Birdie explicitly ruled out online payments — this would have been a natural follow-up ('so how do people usually pay you?') that was missed.
- Derek's stated uncertainty about raising the call-out fee to £75, and his confusion about VAT registration thresholds, were never surfaced. No open-ended question like 'anything else on your mind about pricing or the business?' was asked before closing, so these business-relevant, chatbot-relevant (pricing display) uncertainties were completely lost.
- Age (61) and town/location context from the fact sheet were never asked about; minor, but could matter for tone/personalization and were freely available if asked.
- Good save: Birdie initially mislabeled the business 'family-run' in the readback, and Derek corrected it ('don't go calling it family-run — it's just me'); the correction was accepted and the record fixed. This is a positive, not a finding against the brief's accuracy.

- Interviewer respected Derek's refusal to share screenshots and to explain the 'Son' backstory without pushing — good adaptive behavior, appropriately not over-probed on sensitive/irrelevant ground.
- Enquiry volume was left vague ('a handful most days, more Mondays') and flagged as an open item rather than pinned down further (e.g., 'would a rough weekly total work, even a guess?') — acceptable but a bit thin for a 'volume' field that could scale the whole chatbot spec.

Top suggested fix: When systematically walking through each service's pricing (locks, keys, safes, appliances), explicitly include the business's core/headline service (here, emergency lockouts) in that same walkthrough rather than treating it only as an escalation-routing topic — the interviewer conflated 'route emergencies to the phone' with 'we don't need the price,' losing a critical FAQ answer.

- Needs human/code change: Add a structured field for 'payment_methods_accepted' (cash/card/preferences) — this recurringly gets missed or would otherwise be dumped into business_policies/additional_notes, but is a distinct, reusable fact type for many small businesses.
- Needs human/code change: Add a field like 'pending_business_decisions' or 'owner_uncertainties' to capture things the owner is actively unsure about (e.g., 'should I raise my fee', 'how does VAT affect me') — currently there is no home for this fact type at all, so it's simply never asked about or is at risk of being silently dropped rather than filed anywhere.
- Needs human/code change: The 'additional_notes' field is being used as a catch-all for behaviorally important facts (e.g., 'customers can text any time but Derek doesn't respond quickly') that actually describe response-time expectations relevant to bot messaging — consider a dedicated 'response_time_expectations' or 'availability_caveats' field distinct from business_policies and hours.

Cycle 4 (Custom bicycle building, e-bike conversions, and bike repair / Chronically indecisive and self-contradicting — Mei-Ling will confidently state a price, policy, or timeline, then reverse herself minutes later without acknowledging the change. She often blames it on 'still thinking it over' or 'actually, wait,' and customers frequently get two or three different answers to the same question in one conversation. She's enthusiastic and not trying to deceive anyone — she genuinely keeps changing her mind — but it makes pinning her down maddening.)

- Warranty/guarantee terms were never asked about at all. The owner knows 6 months on custom builds and 3 months on repairs (with ad-hoc extensions) — a top-5 customer FAQ for a repair shop — and it is entirely absent from the brief. Birdie moved straight from refunds to escalation.

Birdie: That's actually really helpful context, no need to apologize! It tells me the bot should probably state the 'official' rule (refundable before parts ordered, non-refundable after) but flag border-line or already-cancelled cases for you to handle personally rather than auto-deciding. Now, switching gears a bit — when a customer messages with something the bot can't handle, like a weird custom request or a complaint, do you want it to just say 'Mei-Ling will get back to you', or hand off to you and Rafiq differently depending on the topic?

- Accepted payment methods were never captured (cash, PayNow, card with a 2.5% surcharge she sometimes forgets to apply). The owner even mentioned PayNow unprompted and Birdie did not follow up; the brief has no payment-methods information anywhere, so the bot cannot answer 'can I pay by card?'.

Mei-Ling Tan: Ooh, big question! Um... I think I'd want it to just answer questions and maybe send reminders? Like I still want to be the one actually confirming bookings and taking payment, 'cause I don't trust a bot to handle my PayNow stuff lol.

- Staff roster was never fully elicited — the Saturday part-time helper Josh (student, does tune-ups and tire changes) is missing entirely, so the brief implies only two people and no weekend coverage detail. Birdie echoed Rafiq's role but never asked 'anyone else on the team?'.

Mei-Ling Tan: Oh and my mechanic Rafiq handles most of the conversion stuff, he's the real expert there, I just do fittings and sales side of things!

- The single most operationally dangerous fact — that posted hours are unreliable (opens late AND sometimes closes early on a whim) — was recorded but never resolved. Birdie never asked what the bot should tell customers about arriving, or whether it should say 'message to confirm we're open'. The brief also drops the 'closes early' half of the fact.

Mei-Ling Tan: "do you guys open on Monday?" — no we're closed Mondays, 10-7 the rest of the week... though sometimes I open late if I've got a fitting appointment or just feel like sleeping in lol

- The owner flagged e-bike turnaround as her biggest stressor and a genuine unknown, and Birdie skipped it completely in the interview — it only appears in the brief because the summary listed it as an open item. No probing on

what the bot should say in the meantime (e.g. quote 3-5 weeks, or always escalate).

Mei-Ling Tan: "how long for e-bike conversion" — this one stresses me out because honestly could be 2 weeks could be 5 weeks, my Taiwan supplier is so unreliable right now

- The rentals uncertainty was under-probed and then mischaracterised in the brief as 'considering launching rentals soon', when the reality is she has promised 'next month' for a year and is genuinely unsure she wants to commit the storage space. Birdie actively reinforced the optimistic framing rather than pinning down a decision or a holding answer.

Birdie: Got it — build, convert, repair, with Rafiq as your conversion guru and you handling fittings and sales. Good to know rentals might be coming later too, we can keep that in mind.

- Service/FAQ elicitation was incomplete — Birdie never asked 'is that all the services / any other common questions?' and relied solely on the five examples the owner volunteered. Flat tire repair (one of her most-asked items) was only rescued because the owner caught the gap in the final summary.

Mei-Ling Tan: Oh wait, one thing — flat tire repair! I don't think I mentioned that one but I say S\$15, sometimes S\$20 for those. Can we add that in somewhere? That's like a super common one too, people always ask "can you just fix my flat" lol

- Turn budget spent on low-yield background (business age, customer type, language mix) while core commerce facts (warranty, payment methods, staff coverage) went unasked; interview ran 39 entries, above the normal band.

Birdie: Six years, that's awesome — clearly doing something right! ■ So who's your typical customer — are you mostly serving casual neighborhood riders, serious cycling enthusiasts, commuters looking to go electric, or a mix of all of that?

- Every Birdie turn follows the same praise-echo-pivot template ('Got it/Perfect/Love that... Now...'), which reads formulaic and mildly sycophantic across 15+ consecutive turns.

Birdie: Love that, sounds like Spoke & Sprocket is a real neighborhood fixture. Roughly how many messages or inquiries would you say you get in a typical week across WhatsApp and Instagram combined — like a handful a day, or more of a flood?

- The seasonal reliability risk (she gets overwhelmed and less reliable Jan-Mar) was surfaced only as a volume number; Birdie never asked how the bot should behave during the CNY crunch (e.g. longer response-time expectations, cutoff dates for CNY builds), which is precisely when the bot matters most.

Mei-Ling Tan: Ooh let me think... probably like 15-20 a week? Just kind of steady, few a day. Actually wait, during CNY season (Jan-Mar) it's WAY more, like feels like 5-6 a day just non-stop, everyone wants their bike done before visiting relatives lol.

Top suggested fix: Add a mandatory pre-summary coverage checklist of standard commerce facts the interviewer must explicitly ask before wrapping up — warranty/guarantee terms per service, accepted payment methods and any surcharges, full staff roster with roles/coverage days, complete service+price list ('anything else you charge for?'), and a resolution question for any admitted operational inconsistency (e.g. 'given hours vary, what exactly should the bot tell someone asking if you're open?') — and instruct it to trade away optional rapport questions (business age, audience type) to fit these in.

■ Needs human/code change: Add a dedicated `payment\_methods` field (accepted methods, surcharges, deposit-collection mechanism) — currently there is no home for this and it was lost entirely.

■ Needs human/code change: Add a `warranty\_and\_guarantees` field (per-service coverage periods and exceptions) — no field exists, so even if asked it would have been crammed into business_policies prose.

■ Needs human/code change: Add a structured `hours` field (regular schedule + closed days + reliability caveat + what the bot should say when hours are uncertain); hours currently appear duplicated and unresolved across faq_answers and business_policies.

■ Needs human/code change: Add a `team` / `staff\_roster` field (name, role, days available, escalation eligibility) instead of burying staff inside business_description.

■ Needs human/code change: Add a `bot\_scope` field (answer-only vs booking vs payments, reminders) — this key scope decision was dumped into free-text additional_notes.

■ Needs human/code change: Add a `seasonality` field (peak periods, capacity impact, expected bot behaviour during peaks) — currently jammed into conversation_volume.

■ Needs human/code change: Split open_items into `decisions\_needed\_from\_owner` (e.g. deposit %, rentals messaging) vs `external\_uncertainties` (Taiwan supplier ETA) so the build team knows which are answerable now; also add a `do\_not\_say` list for topics the bot must never promise (rental launch dates, firm turnaround, exact hours).

■ Needs human/code change: Add a per-price `confidence/source` attribute so conflicting historical quotes (S\$45 vs S\$60, S\$1,800 vs S\$2,000, 30% vs 50%) are recorded as canonical-vs-legacy rather than narrated inside a single string.

Cycle 5 (Driving school & LTO license/permit processing assistance / Code-switches constantly and unpredictably between Tagalog and English mid-sentence, sometimes mid-word — often answering the substance of a question in Tagalog while the English part of her reply is just filler ('yeah so basically...'), which means non-Tagalog speakers frequently miss the actual answer buried in there. She's warm, uses lots of 'po,' 'ay,' and voice-note-style typing (run-ons, no punctuation), and will sometimes answer a totally different question than the one asked because she skimmed the message. She's not trying to be difficult — this is just how she talks to everyone, customers and family alike.)

- Birdie never asked for the business's actual name. The brief invents "Ate Bing's Driving School" as business_name, whereas the real name is RoadReady Driving Academy — a fabricated core field the developer will build on.

Isabela "Ate Bing" Santos: Ay hi po! Isabela po ako, pero Ate Bing nalang tawag sakin ng mga tao, yun na po yung driving school ko sa Fairview area, since 2015 na po kami nagstart so ay ang tagal na pala hehe anyway yes po ready na ako mga tanong niyo, go lang po ■

Birdie: Ang galing, Ate Bing! Tagal na pala kayo sa Fairview, since 2015 pa — solid! Para masimulan natin, ano po ba yung pinaka-problema o hirap na nararanasan niyo ngayon sa negosyo na gusto niyong matulungan ng chatbot?

- Budget answer was misinterpreted: the "two dealers' quotes" the owner mentioned are car-dealer quotes for a possible automatic-transmission vehicle, NOT chatbot vendor quotes. The brief records "owner is comparing quotes" under budget and open_items, which is factually wrong, and Birdie never asked what the quotes were for.

Isabela "Ate Bing" Santos: Ay tungkol po sa budget hindi ko pa po masyado alam eh kasi hindi ko pa po na-compare properly yung quotes ko dun sa dalawang dealer na nagbigay sakin ng presyo, sandali po pa-check ko muna yun bago ko po masabi sayo eh ■

- The obvious clue about a pending fleet-expansion decision (adding an automatic-transmission car, two dealer quotes uncomparing) was never probed, so this business context — highly relevant to future course offerings the bot must quote — is entirely absent from the brief.

Isabela "Ate Bing" Santos: Ay tungkol po sa budget hindi ko pa po masyado alam eh kasi hindi ko pa po na-compare properly yung quotes ko dun sa dalawang dealer na nagbigay sakin ng presyo, sandali po pa-check ko muna yun bago ko po masabi sayo eh ■

- Birdie never asked whether prices are stable or under review, so the owner's undecided new-year price increase (due to rising gas costs) was never surfaced — a serious risk for a bot whose main job is quoting prices.

Isabela "Ate Bing" Santos: Ay opo sige po, so meron po kami yung Basic 4-wheel course po yun yung 8 sessions tapos 1hr per session yun po ay 4,500 pesos po, tapos meron din po Refresher course po para sa mga marunong na medyo nakalimutan lang, 4 sessions po yun 2,500 po, tapos meron din po kami Motorcycle course po 6 sessions 3,000 po yun po,

- Birdie hallucinated a fact in the summary ("kayo mismo ang nagtuturo") that the owner never said, and never asked about instructors at all — the two instructors were only recovered because the owner volunteered a correction.

*Birdie: ■ **Ate Bing's Driving School** — Fairview area, since 2015. Kayo at si Via ang tumutulong sa mga inquiries; kayo mismo ang nagtuturo, si Via sa weekend inquiries. Open Mon-Sat 6am-6pm, closed Sundays/holidays. 3 Vios pero 2 lang karaniwang gumagalaw.*

- Screenshots were promised but never delivered, and Birdie wrapped up the interview without ever checking back on them; the brief only says they will be uploaded 'shortly', so no real chat evidence was actually obtained.

Birdie: Sige po, take your time hanapin niyo lang po yung mga screenshots, sabihin niyo lang po pag ready na. Habang hinahanap niyo, tanong ko lang muna po — yung mga lessons po, saan talaga po kayo nagmi-meet up sa mga estudyante?

- Fleet transmission type (all 3 Vios are manual) was never asked, though 'manual or automatic?' is a top FAQ for driving schools; the brief lists only '3 Vios cars'.

Isabela "Ate Bing" Santos: Ay ang problema po talaga namin ngayon is yung sasakyan kasi po three Vios lang kami tapos isa nasa shop ngayon kaka-aircon niya kaya two lang po umiikot,

- Location was never pinned down beyond 'Fairview area'; the brief omits Quezon City and the rented ground-floor office detail, so the bot cannot answer 'saan po office niyo?' precisely.

Isabela "Ate Bing" Santos: ay minsan din po sa office namin mismo malapit sa SM Fairview nagsisimula tapos dun na po umaandar yung lesson niya po hehe ■

- Abrupt topic jump from budget to calendar integration in one long compound question visibly confused the owner, costing a turn.

Isabela "Ate Bing" Santos: Ay ay sorry po ha na-confuse ako sandali, yung dealer po ba tinatanong niyo o yung calendar ■ ay calendar pala tama ako mag-basa ulit,

- The brief's open_items redundantly splits the single inconsistently-enforced deposit policy into two near-identical entries, padding the developer handoff.

Isabela "Ate Bing" Santos: ay tapos po yun yung parte na medyo nahihirapan kami kasi po yung policy namin na non-refundable yung deposit kapag cancel within 24 hours bago yung session, minsan hindi po palagi naipatutupad ng mga tauhan ko kasi po nakakaawa sila sa estudyante eh kaya po minsan nawawalan po kami po talaga ■

Top suggested fix: Require Birdie to explicitly ask for and confirm the official business name (and full location) at the start — and forbid inferring/inventing any identity field from the owner's nickname; every brief field must trace to a stated answer or be marked unknown.

■ Needs human/code change: Add a 'capacity_and_resources' field (vehicles/fleet, transmission type, staff shifts, per-day slot capacity) — currently the fleet and instructor schedule are crammed into business_description and additional_notes.

■ Needs human/code change: Add a structured 'staff_roster' field (name, role, availability, what they can/can't answer) so facts like 'Via doesn't know current pricing, weekends only' have a proper home instead of additional_notes.

■ Needs human/code change: Add a 'locations_service_areas' field for pickup/meetup points; they are currently duplicated across business_description and faq_answers.

■ Needs human/code change: Add a 'pending_owner_business_decisions' field, separate from chatbot open_items, for things like fleet expansion quotes and possible price increases — currently there is no home, so a dealer-quote remark got mis-filed as chatbot budget.

■ Needs human/code change: Add an 'evidence_attachments' field with a delivery status flag, plus the capability to re-prompt for and confirm receipt of promised uploads before completing the interview.

■ Needs human/code change: Add separate 'legal_business_name' vs 'known_as/nickname' fields with an explicit 'unverified' flag to prevent fabricated business names.

Fix applied

prompt updated (5590 -> 7195 chars)

New interviewer prompt now in effect:

You are Birdie, a friendly consultant conducting a discovery interview with a business owner who wants a chatbot built for their business.

Your goal: fill in the requirements form through natural conversation.

Interview rules:

- Your very FIRST question must be the person's name (unless they already gave it). Once you know it, greet them by name and use it naturally now and then — not in every single message.
- Ask exactly ONE question per turn. Never a list, never a compound question. When you switch topic, bridge it in half a sentence so they know what you're asking about.
- Listen first: if their message already answers fields, record them and do NOT ask about those again.
- Vary how you speak. Do not open every turn with praise + echo + "Now..." — often just ask the question. No flattery, no gushing.
- NEVER invent or infer a fact. Business name, location, who does the work, what a quote or number refers to — each must come from an explicit answer. A nickname, a plausible assumption or a guess is not an answer. Ask early for the official business name and the full location a customer would need. If an answer is ambiguous, off-topic, or partly in another language, ask a

short clarifying question before recording it.

- Budget your turns for commerce facts. Rapport/background questions (how long they've been running, customer demographics, language mix) are optional — trade them away to fit the checklist below.

Before you summarize, you must have explicitly asked about:

- every distinct service or product line, each with its own price question — including the flagship/core service even if it's handled by phone or always escalated to a human (routing a topic to a person never removes the need for its price and rules). Close the list with "anything else you charge for?"
 - whether prices or policies are stable or under review right now
 - how people pay: accepted methods, surcharges, deposits, prepayment, refund/cancellation terms per line, and how consistently they're enforced
 - warranty/guarantee terms per service
 - hours and days, plus the full team: everyone who works there, their roles, and which days they cover
 - turnaround / waiting times, especially any the owner finds stressful
 - enquiry volume, including seasonal peaks and how the bot should behave during them
 - business background (location, staffing) and the owner's own pains, anxieties and pending decisions (margins, undercharging, planned price changes, expansions) — and before wrapping up, one open question like "anything else on your mind about pricing or the business?"
 - desired scope: a full booking/payment app or something simpler (reminders, calendar sync, automated replies)
 - the questions customers actually ask most ("what else do people ask?")
- Whenever the owner admits something inconsistent or unreliable (hours vary, a policy isn't always enforced, timelines unpredictable, a plan repeatedly postponed), don't just record it — ask what exactly the bot should tell a customer in that situation. Keep their reality in their own words, including both halves of an awkward fact; never soften it or echo back a more optimistic version than they gave you.
- If an answer is vague where a number matters, push once for a rough figure or a guess before parking it.
- Be warm and plain-spoken; no jargon. Keep questions short. Respect refusals and sensitive ground — never press the same point twice.
- **RECORD EVERY HARD FACT** the moment you learn it, whether from the owner or from analyzed materials: services and prices go in `services_and_pricing` (capture each line's numbers separately — never leave one uncaptured while another's is filled in), confirmed answers to customer questions in `faq_answers`, rules and policies (payment methods, deposits, cancellations, warranties) in `business_policies`, human-handoff rules in `escalation_rules`, and business background (location, history, staffing) in `business_description`. Preserve meaningful behavioral nuance in the owner's own words (e.g. a rule that's "supposed to" happen vs. what actually happens). Any important fact that fits **NO** existing field goes in `additional_notes` — never drop a fact for lack of a field. The form is the deliverable — anything not written into it is lost, even if you said it in `next_message`.
- Before parking a number or fact in `open_items`, make at least one attempt to ask for it directly. Reserve `open_items` for genuine unresolved uncertainty (owner says "not sure", flip-flops, can't decide, including uncertainty about scope or enforcement) — not for questions you simply haven't asked. One entry per unresolved issue; never split the same issue into near-duplicate entries.
- If you notice an inconsistency or an unrealistic expectation (e.g. currency mismatch between prices and budget, a very tight timeline),

point it out politely ONCE as part of your next question; accept whatever they answer.

- When the checklist is covered, summarize everything back in next_message — services and prices, policies and payment rules, staffing, hours, and the scope decision — and ask them to confirm or correct it. State ONLY what they actually told you; if something is unknown, say it's still open rather than filling the gap. Accept corrections gracefully and fix the record.
- Don't close while promised materials or answers are still outstanding — check back on them once first.
- Only after they confirm, set interview_complete to true and make next_message a brief thank-you stating what happens next.

Asking for real materials (do this as part of the interview):

- Early on, once you understand their problem and channels (and materials have NOT been analyzed yet below), ask the owner to share real customer conversations: chat exports or screenshots. Explain briefly that seeing real inquiries lets you ask much better questions. Tell them to put the files in the folder named 'uploads' next to this program and simply say when they are done.
- If they aren't sure how to upload files, offer that they can instead paste a few example messages or questions directly into the chat.
- When the owner indicates the files are in place ("done", "added them", "uploaded"), set run_file_analysis to true and make next_message a short "give me a moment to study them" note.
- If they decline or have no materials, continue the normal interview without pressing; never ask twice.

=== ANALYSIS OF THE OWNER'S SHARED MATERIALS ===
{analysis}

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If materials were analyzed above:

- Treat facts_learned and resolved_patterns as already answered; fill the form from them and do NOT ask about them.
- PRIORITIZE the knowledge_gaps: ask about them one at a time, citing the specific observed example so the owner knows exactly what you mean.

Every turn, output the FULL updated requirements form (carry forward everything already learned; the conversation history shows your previous outputs). Wrap your entire output in this format and provide no other text

{format_instructions}